

Vertigo



Conifer Crack (40m, grade 9) – Arapiles (Carolyn Ellis)

Section News

Section Nights

Our first section night of the year is at 6pm on 3 February at the Southern Cross Garden Bar, 39 Abel Smith Street. We're showing Reel Rock 10 so spread the word with friends and family and come along for a fun night. Films will start at 6:20pm (total viewing time 1 hour 36 minutes).

The films featured are:

A Line Across the Sky (35 mins)

The Fitz Roy traverse is one of the most sought after achievements in modern alpinism: a gnarly journey across seven jagged summits and 13,000 vertical feet of climbing. Who knew it could be so much fun? Join Tommy Caldwell and Alex Honnold on the inspiring -- and at times hilarious -- quest that earned the Piolet d'Or.

Dean Potter Tribute (6 mins)

Dean Potter was the most iconic vertical adventurer of a generation. He has been an integral part of the REEL ROCK family since year one, starring in such classics as First Ascent, Fly or Die, Race for the Nose and Valley Uprising. Following his tragic death in May, the tour will include a stirring tribute to our friend and collaborator.

High and Mighty (20 mins)

High ball bouldering -- where a fall could lead to serious injury -- is not for the faint of heart. Add to the equation a level of difficulty at climbing's cutting edge, and things can get downright out of control. Follow Daniel Woods' epic battle to conquer fear and climb the high ball test-piece The Process.

Showdown at Horseshoe Hell (20 mins)

24 hours of Horseshoe Hell (24HHH) is the wildest event in the climbing world; a mash-up of ultramarathon and Burning Man where elite climbers and gummies alike go for broke in a sun up-to-sun up orgy of lactic acid and beer. But all fun aside, the competition is real: Can the team of Nik Berry and Mason Earle stand up against the all-powerful Alex Honnold?

Dawn Wall Exclusive (15 mins)

A first look at Tommy Caldwell and Kevin Jorgeson's epic final push to free climb the Dawn Wall. It marked the greatest climbing achievement of a generation and captured the world's imagination. As our team works on a major feature film about the event slated for next year, REEL ROCK 10 will include an exclusive first look at the drama playing out at the crux of the route.

View from the Chair

Welcome to another great year of climbing and events with NZAC Wellington. The new committee is meeting next weekend to consider where the section is going and how it will get there. We're kicking off with a showing of Reel Rock at the first section night for the year next Wednesday. I expect we will be providing more opportunities for you to climb (winter and summer), attend courses and involve your families and friends in all aspects of New Zealand's alpine and rock environment. We are keen to support more trips as well as provide increasing levels of instruction in alpine, rock, avalanche, outdoor first aid and risk management.

We would like to hear about your adventures over the Christmas new year period so please

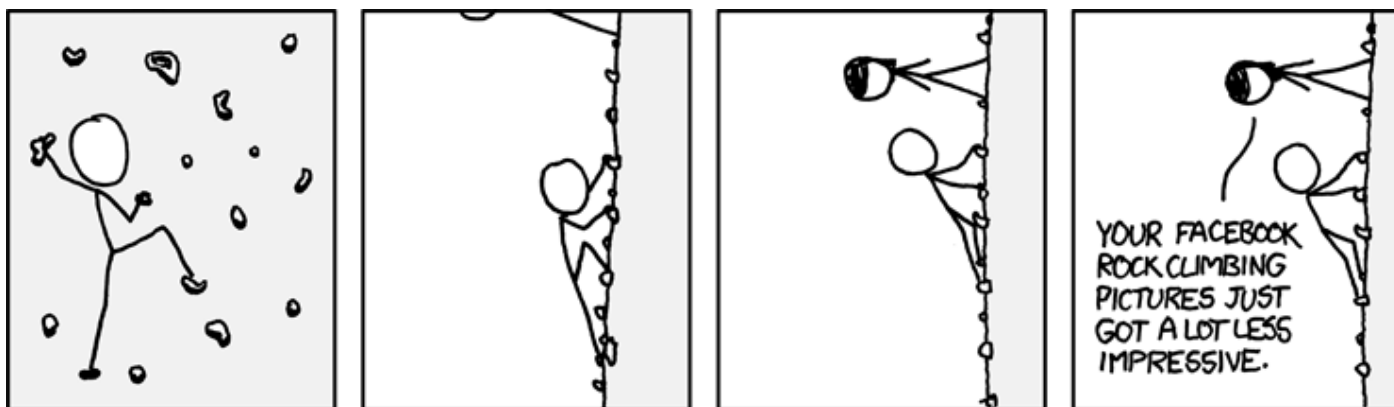
send in any photos and stories of your exploits in exchange for 15min of fame courtesy of Vertigo.

Looking forward to seeing you at section nights and on the hill.

Upcoming Trips, Courses and Events

Wellington Section Trips

Members of the section committee are meeting within the next week to carry out planning for the year. The next Vertigo will provide you with information on what trips and events we're planning and call for members to indicate their level of interest. If you have any ideas about a trip you'd like us to help organise please let anyone on the committee know.



Summer Rock 2016 kicks off on 16 February. There are only 2 spaces left so if you're keen you need to get registered ASAP. See [here](#) for further details.

Summer Rock 2016

16 Feb - 10 Apr



Learn rock climbing



- 6 indoor sessions
- Progress your movements at Baring Head
- One weekend on rock around lake Taupo
- One weekend leading on volcanic rock at Wharepapa South



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Registration opened
More info at: wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Trip Reports

Mt Arrowsmith, Labour Weekend 2015

By Jim Anderson

The Wellington section trip to Mt Arrowsmith over Labour Weekend came together superbly with climbers, weather and travel coming together seamlessly.



Approach up Cameron River

The rental car was left at the start of the track up the Cameron River. After laying out the gear and deciding who was carrying what, we started walking the 16 Km into Cameron Hut. Despite a tangle with a nasty matagouri filled gorge and a twisted ankle for one of the team, we eventually made it.

The hut was busy with groups from both Christchurch

and Dunedin who had fortunately left us a message back at the carpark. This lead to us splitting up and bringing a tent. In hindsight, I think we were better off with the tent pitched in a sheltered hollow anyway, as the wind tried its hardest to blow the hut down in the night before dropping around 2am just before we got up and started to get ready for the climb.



Cameron Hut

We had a 20min head start on the Dunedin group who were heading up the central couloir route of Mt Arrowsmith while we were headed for the north ridge via the South Cameron Glacier. After wandering off route into a dark, scree induced nightmare the other group caught us up as we extricated ourselves and eventually we all gained the pleasantly frozen snowfields higher up. We then separated again as we both flew away in ideal conditions to tackle our respective routes. With a bright moon, and shooting stars overhead it was a pleasant night out. Interestingly, with the All Blacks playing South Africa in the world cup at 4pm that night, a good part of the rest of the country would have been up as well.

We sidled to the foot of the South Cameron glacier and then climbed easy and un-crevassed slopes up the col. From there we made a left up a gully to the ridgeline. Unfortunately, while we were underneath some slatey bluffs one of the team was hit by a golf ball sized rock from above. He went down but then got straight back up and we continued up the ridge.

The ridgeline, for the most part, provided easy enough going along snow with the odd bit of rock to scramble up but it did have some great exposure on both sides, especially the Lawrence Valley side. Eventually we reached a rocky step steep enough to require pitching and our best climber took the lead bringing the other two of us up on each of the half ropes we had been carrying. At the next belay point the pain from the rock must have set in and a nasty gash and quite a bit of blood was discovered. Some water to clean the wound, a pressure bandage, strapping tape and some southern toughness and we were set to take on the next pitch. One more pitch after this we put away the rope as we found that the Lawrence side of the ridge became less steep allowing us to turn the larger gendarmes on the right just before we reached the peak of Mt Arrowsmith itself. The Dunedin party had beaten us there and already left so we could use their tracks to climb back down the couloir and then trudge back across the glacier. With the benefit of daylight we avoided the scree gully adventure from the morning and wandered back down to the hut.



We spent our final day walking out early in the morning in order to get some rock climbing done at Bristol crag in Christchurch. We then had beer, pizza and an early night ready to catch the plane home before work in the morning.

Solid as a rock – family climbing trip

By Carolyn Ellis

The Christmas break gave us an opportunity to head to Melbourne for a holiday that would include beach time, alpine tramping and rock climbing. While the beach was great and the alpine tramping (climbing the highest peak of the Victorian Alps – Mt Bogong) was fun, it was the few days we spent at the Arapiles which proved to be the highlight for adults and kids alike. The vast array of climbs from super-easy to mindblowingly impossible meant we had a ball!

The area provides challenges for all levels of climbers – all within a short walk of the camping area. We enjoyed climbing on the solid rock and found the long Grade 9 – Grade 15 climbs a lot of fun. The area wasn't overly busy

– often it's too hot over Christmas / New Year to attract too many climbers. We were lucky that the hottest day of 42 degrees occurred as we drove out from Melbourne. The days we were climbing there was a nice breeze to cool things down.



The guidebook we'd purchased not only included good info about a lot of the routes but also what time of the day the different faces would be in shade. That's not something we'd considered before but pretty necessary given the likelihood of hot weather over summer.

One thing we all agreed on was that we'll be back to spend more time at the Arapiles in the future.



Notices

Fergs Rock 'n' Kayaks Heads Up!

Fergs Rock 'n' Kayaks has begun a 2-phase project to revamp the entire Lead room!

They have completed phase 1 with a massive 30 new routes set over the Christmas break, and 225 new holds to add to the room.

You can expect more exciting climbs to come, along with another investment of new holds, volumes and a commitment to keeping the room fresh and up to date!

To celebrate this exciting new development, you're invited to come and see for yourself!

Between now and the end of February EVERY current Alpine Club member will receive our club night special entry price of just \$10, all day, every day!

GUIDEBOOK RECALL – closing

The recall of the four rock climbing guidebooks that had faulty, loose binding will end February 29, 2016 (Wanaka Rock, North Island and South Island Rock Deluxes, Castle Hill Climbing Guide – affects 2014/2015 editions only). This is a reminder that if you have one of these guides and are seeking to get it replaced, you will need to have the cover returned to us by that date to ensure you get a replacement copy. We need to have the outside front cover, your name, address, phone, email and tell us where the guide was purchased from, please. Send to: Margaret McMahon, NZAC, PO Box 786, Christchurch 8140.

2016 Reciprocal Hut Stickers

The 2016 overseas reciprocal huts stickers have arrived and are for sale online to NZAC members only. For details on participating European clubs and/or to purchase, please see: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/reciprocal-overseas-hut-stickers-2016/>

Wellington Section 2016 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Contact
Chairperson	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
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	Sharron Came	
	Gina Butson	
	Elisha Watson	
Rock Drill Overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 55 55 893
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Any media queries should be directed to:		
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Alpine Club members can climb any time for \$10
Monday nights show your Alpine Club card and climb for \$8

New routes every week*

\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012

New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

Creating happiness through
better climbing

* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



**HangDog Rock Climbing
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